

State Performance Targets Framework

Elementary Education (Grades K–5) Accountability Metrics & Guidance

Scope: Public K-5 Schools (ESSA & State Accountability)

Target Focus: Proficiency, Growth, Attendance & Equity

Framework: ESSA Title I & IDEA Part B Compliance

Under the **Every Student Succeeds Act (ESSA)** and individual state educational codes, state performance targets establish transparent, measurable benchmarks for K-5 elementary schools. These metrics hold school districts accountable for academic mastery, individual growth, language acquisition, and equitable student access.

1. Overview of K-5 Performance Indicators

Indicator Category	Primary Metric / Measure	Target Standard	Weight / Scope
ACADEMIC ACHIEVEMENT	Grades 3–5 ELA & Math Proficiency on State Summative Assessments	Annual increase in % meeting or exceeding standards	30% – 40% of overall school score
ACADEMIC GROWTH	Student Growth Percentile (SGP) or Value-Added Growth models	Mean SGP ≥ 50 across reading and mathematics	30% – 40% of overall school score
ENGLISH LANGUAGE PROFICIENCY	WIDA ACCESS / ELPAC Progress for Multilingual Learners (K–5)	Target % of EL students demonstrating annual proficiency gains	10% – 15% of overall school score
SCHOOL QUALITY & SUCCESS	Chronic Absenteeism Rate (% missing ≥ 10% of school days)	Maintain total chronic absenteeism below 10%–12%	10% – 15% of overall school score
SPECIAL EDUCATION (IDEA)	Least Restrictive Environment (LRE) & Participation (SPP Indicators 3 & 5)	≥ 95% assessment participation; ≥ 80% time in general class	Federal Compliance (SPP/APR)

2. Deep-Dive into Core Metric Categories

A. Early Literacy & Mathematics (Grades K–3)

Early grade literacy is universally treated as a high-stakes foundational milestone:

- Grade 3 Reading Benchmark:** States set explicit performance targets for Grade 3 reading proficiency. Passing is frequently tied to statutory promotion policies.
- Foundational Math:** Focuses on Grade 3–5 growth in numeric operations, early fractions, and multistep problem solving.
- K–2 Diagnostic Screening:** Universal screeners (e.g., DIBELS, i-Ready, MAP) measure benchmark status 3x per year.

B. Subgroup Performance & Gap Closure

ESSA requires distinct performance targets for disaggregated student groups:

- Economically Disadvantaged Students
- Students with Disabilities (IEP/504)
- English Language Learners (ELL)
- Racial and Ethnic Minorities

Gap Closure Target: States require schools to accelerate progress for the lowest-performing 25% of students at 1.5x the rate of the overall student population.

Key Formula: Student Growth Percentile (SGP) Calculation

Growth is evaluated relative to academic peers who shared similar historical score histories. Target SGP is defined as: $SGP_{\{target\}} = ext{Median}\{left(SGP_{\{student_i\}}\ right)\} ge 50$, ensuring that average growth exceeds expectations for low-performing cohorts.

3. IDEA Part B Special Education Indicators (Elementary K–5)

Under the Individuals with Disabilities Education Act (IDEA), states track specific State Performance Plan (SPP) targets for K-5 students receiving special education services:

Indicator	Metric Name	Target Objective
Indicator 3A	Assessment Participation Rate	At least 95% of students with IEPs participate in general state assessments or alternate assessments (e.g., Dynamic Learning Maps).
Indicator 3B/ 3C	Assessment Proficiency Rate	Target performance percentage on grade-level state standards with standard accommodations or alternate scoring.
Indicator 5A	LRE: Regular Class $\geq 80\%$	Maximize the percentage of K–5 special education students educated in general classrooms for 80% or more of the school day.
Indicator 5B	LRE: Regular Class $< 40\%$	Minimize the percentage of K–5 special education students placed in separate classrooms for more than 60% of the school day.
Indicator 4	Significant Disproportionality	Eliminate disproportionate rates of discipline/suspension among students with disabilities by race or ethnicity.

4. Implementation Checklist for K-5 Administrators

- **Formative Interim Assessments:** Administer BOY, MOY, and EOY screeners (e.g., MAP, NWEA, STAR) to monitor trajectory toward state targets.
- **Attendance Intervention Frameworks:** Implement Tier 2 and Tier 3 attendance nudges when students miss $> 51\%$ of instructional days.
- **Multilingual Progress Plans:** Track annual language proficiency gains on WIDA/ELPAC levels for all English Learners.
- **IEP Alignment:** Ensure IEP goals directly connect to grade-level state standards and accommodations matching state testing rules.